

1754

FRENCH AND INDIAN WAR

The War of 1754–63 was one of several fought by France and Britain over supremacy in North America. The British lost several forts before going on the offensive in 1758 and securing a victory at Quebec in September 1759. The war ended with the Seven Years War, in 1763. It gave Britain control of North America but also fuelled resentment of British exploitation among American colonists.



▽ Battle scene from the French and Indian War



1706–90

BENJAMIN FRANKLIN

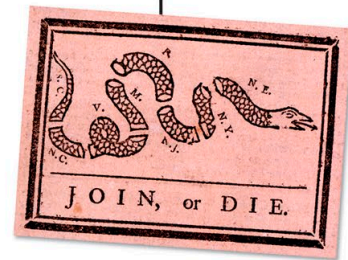
A successful writer and scientist from Philadelphia who demonstrated the electrical nature of lightning and invented bifocal spectacles, Franklin was also among the creators of the US Constitution.

1754

1753 Scottish doctor James Lind outlines his theory that citrus fruit can cure scurvy among sailors

1754 BENJAMIN FRANKLIN PROPOSES UNITY OF THE AMERICAN COLONIES

At the Albany Congress of June–July 1754, Benjamin Franklin presented his Plan of Union, suggesting that the colonies unite in a loose confederation, presided over by a president general and with authority to levy taxes. The plan was not implemented, but it contained the seeds of American independence.



△ Benjamin Franklin cartoon

1750–85 ART FOR THE PUBLIC



1750 The Musée du Luxembourg displays pieces, including work by Leonardo (above) from the collection of Louis XV.



1753 Sir John Soane donates 71,000 objects to Britain; they form the basis of the British Museum, the first public national museum in the world.



1764 The Hermitage Museum is created by Catherine the Great in St Petersburg to house Russia's vast royal collections.



1785 The Prado Museum is built to house the Natural History Cabinet of King Charles III (above); it opens to the public in 1819.

Many of Europe's great museums were founded in the 18th century as Europe's royalty put their collections on public display.